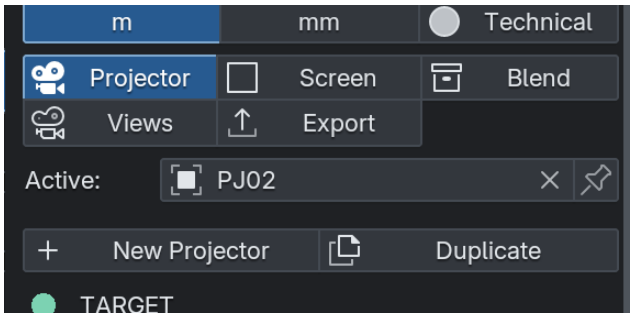
Beam Quick Start

Twisted Pixel • A first projection study in two pages



1 Install and open Beam

Install beam-0.13.0.zip from Preferences → Add-ons → menu → Install from Disk. Enable Beam and save preferences if needed. Restart after replacing an older build. In the 3D View press F3, search Open Beam Workspace and run it. On Mac use Edit → Menu Search if F3 is intercepted. View → Open Beam Workspace is also available.

2 Add and position a screen

Start in an empty scene: in a new General file, select the default objects in the 3D View with A and delete them with X, then confirm. Choose Screen → New Screen. Set Width 6, Height 3.375, Aspect Free and Origin Bottom Centre; click Create Screen. With SCR001 selected, use G Y 8 Enter, then G Z -1.6875 Enter. The screen centre is now eight metres along +Y at projector height.

3 Add a projector and check its target

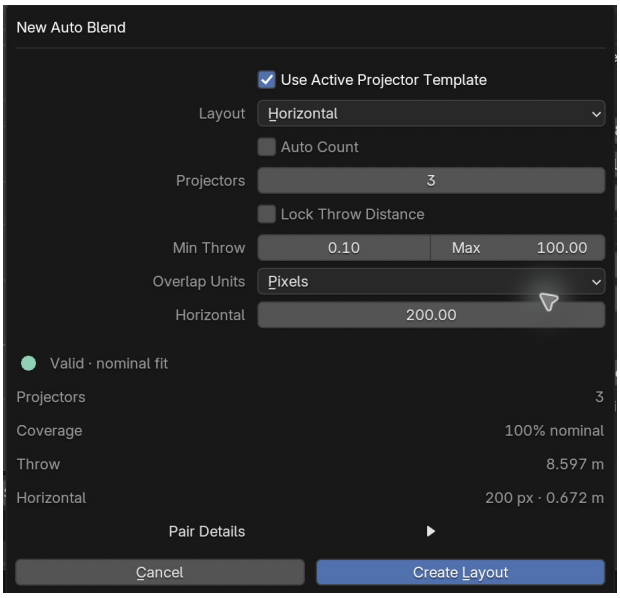
Choose Projector → New Projector. Keep it at the origin facing +Y. Use resolution 1920 × 1080, Throw Ratio 1.00 and zero shift. Choose Calibration Grid. Confirm TARGET; Calculated should read Throw 8 m and Width 8 m. If needed use Aim / Position → Click Surface to aim at the screen centre.

4 Make the image six metres wide

Click the Width pencil, enter 6 m, choose Solve By: Lens / Throw Ratio, keep Target locked and Lens unlocked, then click the checkmark. Confirm Width 6 m and Ratio 1.333.

Optional appearance: Project / Workspace → Apply Beam Theme. Restore Previous Theme reverses it. File → Save As saves your study.

Build and hand off a layout



5 Create a new three-projector layout

For this example, select SCR001, change Width to 18 m and click Update Screen. Choose New Auto Blend: Horizontal, Count 3, Auto Count off, overlap 200 px, Use Active Projector Template on, Lock Throw off. Keep the 1.333 practice projector active as the template. Confirm Valid, then Create Layout. The tested throw is about 8.597 m.

New Auto Blend adds projectors; the original practice projector remains. Hide or remove it when you want only the layout. For an existing BG01 use Blend → Reflow Group instead of creating another layout.

6 Save a review view

Navigate to show the projectors and screen. Choose Views → New Study View and name it Overview. Use View to recall it. Set export dimensions and inspect This View · Export Annotations. Save the .blend.

7 Export and verify

Choose Export → Study Package · JSON + HTML + Views. Enter a new folder name, leave Render Study Views on and export. Check beam-study.json, index.html and the views folder. Use Mapping Matter CSV only for that format; use Designer CSV for the Designer workflow. Keep metadata sidecars.

Next: open the supplied training project and follow its companion for all five Surface Analysis modes, occlusion, Observer Acuity and Reverse Mapping. PATCH document composition is a separate integration workflow still in testing.